AMYPO - Policy & Placement Copilot

User Manual

How to sign in, ask a question you can trust, and use the placement, dashboard and admin screens. Written for students, staff and administrators.

Applies to: version 0.1.0, build 2026-10-19

Where: http://localhost:3000 after docker compose up

Demo accounts: admin / staff.cse / s102, password amypo-demo-2026

Every answer is cited; the system abstains when it cannot support one

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1. Sign in

Open `http://localhost:3000`. The sign-in page asks for the username your department issued - not an email link, no password reset by mail, because the product is designed to run offline.

Account	Password	Lands on	Use it to try
admin	amypo-demo-2026	Dashboard	Users, ingestion, evaluation, audit
staff.cse	amypo-demo-2026	Chat	Cohort queries, matching, staff documents
s102	amypo-demo-2026	Chat	Own grades, eligibility, skill gap

These are demo accounts, seeded only when the stack runs in demo mode. An administrator can create real accounts on the Users screen; passwords are hashed individually and never shown again.

If sign-in fails

- **Incorrect username or password** - deliberately vague, so the form cannot be used to discover which usernames exist.
- **Too many attempts** - wait a minute; the throttle is per account and per address.

• **Session expired** - you were idle too long, or the server restarted with a new signing key. Sign in again; nothing you asked is lost.

• **Backend unreachable** - the API container is down or still starting. Check `docker compose ps`; the first start after a rebuild takes a few seconds.

2. Ask a question

Type into the chat box and press Enter. Ask about a rule, a record, a placement decision or the system itself. The product answers from three kinds of evidence: policy documents, your own records, and the placement criteria table.

Questions that work well

Instead of	Ask
tell me about attendance	What is the minimum attendance required for exams?
grades	What is my CGPA?
placement	Am I eligible for the Zoho SDE role?
skills	What skills am I missing for a data analyst role?
fees	What is the refund policy for hostel fees?
rules	How are end-semester papers moderated?

Specific is better for a simple reason: retrieval ranks passages by the words in the question, and the verifier then checks the answer against those passages. A question that names the thing it is about - a rule, a course code, a company and role - gives both steps something to work with.

You can ask follow-ups in the same conversation; recent questions are listed in the sidebar, and New chat starts a clean thread. The sidebar is hideable on narrow screens.

3. Read the answer

An answer is more than a paragraph. Each part tells you how much to trust it.

Element	What it means
Answer text	The answer, with [S1], [S2] markers where a claim came from a source
Confidence	How much of the answer the verifier could support; under the floor the answer becomes an abstention
Route badge	Which tier answered: cache, offline (extractive), local model, or cloud
Citations	One chip per source; open it to read the exact sentence or row used
Trace panel	Every stage: understanding, tools, placement, retrieval, generation, verification, with timings
Conflict notice	Two records disagree (for example 75% and 60% attendance rules); both are shown, neither is hidden
Degraded banner	The model is unavailable, so the answer is extractive and cannot paraphrase

A citation is a record id, not a guess: document chunks look like `doc:attendance-policy#2` and record rows like `db:attendance:S102:CS301`. The Evaluation screen checks that every cited id really exists in the corpus, which is how citation validity is measured at 100%.

4. When it abstains

An abstention is a real answer, not an error. It means the evidence was too weak to stand behind, and the product prefers saying so to inventing something plausible.

The reply names the closest records it did find and offers a clarifying question. Read the list: it often shows what the corpus does contain, which is usually enough to rephrase. For example, asking for the Wi-Fi password returns the hostel policy and the security runbook as the closest records - the corpus never contains a password, and the answer says so.

What to do next: name the document, course, company or record you mean; ask about one thing at a time; and if you are a student, remember that questions about someone else's record are refused rather than answered.

5. Student guide

Sign in as `s102` (or your own account) and land on Chat. What you can do:

- **Your own record.** 'What is my CGPA?', 'What is my attendance in CS301?' - answered from the database and cited to your row.
- **Policies.** Attendance, exams, fees, hostel, internship, scholarship, library; every answer cites the clause it came from.
- **Eligibility.** 'Am I eligible for the Zoho SDE role?' gives a yes or no with each failing criterion spelled out (CGPA, backlogs, attendance, skills).
- **Skill gap and what-if.** The Placement screen shows what is missing for a target role and what a hypothetical CGPA or skill level would change.
- **Download.** The eligibility report exports as a PDF you can attach to an application.

You cannot see another student's record, staff-only or admin-only documents, the cohort tools, or the system screens. If you ask anyway, the reply is a refusal - 'records for other students are outside your access scope' - and the attempt is written to the audit log.

6. Staff guide

Staff accounts carry a department assignment, and that assignment is the boundary: a CSE staff member sees CSE students and the staff handbook, and nothing from another department. Sign in as `staff.cse`.

- **Cohort questions.** 'Who is eligible for Capgemini Analyst?' returns a ranked list with the criteria each student meets or misses; the query is recorded in the cohort trail.
- **Matching.** The Placement screen ranks candidates for a role by criteria, with fairness checks on the shortlist.
- **Staff documents.** The faculty handbook and placement internals are visible to you and invisible to students; answers cite them like any other source.
- **Criteria.** You can edit the requirements of companies assigned to you. Other companies are read-only, and the change is audited.
- **Dashboard.** Read-only: live RAM, bandwidth, quota, route mix, latency and quality. It is monitoring, not a control panel.

Staff cannot open Users, Ingestion, Router or Evaluation, and cannot read the admin audit log. The screens are absent from the navigation, and a direct URL shows 'Not permitted'.

7. Admin guide

Admins see the system side: the accounts, the corpus, the router, the evaluation harness and the audit trail. Students appear only in aggregate, unless an audited query names them.

Screen	What you do there
Users	Create accounts, set role and department, disable someone who leaves
Knowledge	See corpus size and document scopes, re-run ingestion after adding files

Screen	What you do there
Evaluation	Run the benchmark, read accuracy, abstention and cost, open the full report
Dashboard	Self-optimising router: retrain from the benchmark plus thumbs feedback, then compare the two accuracies
Audit trail	Every denial, login, cohort query and personal-record read, with actor and route
Router	See the route the policy would choose for a question, and the reason

Ingestion is idempotent: unchanged files are skipped by content hash, so re-running it after adding a document only embeds the new one. The response reports documents, chunks, record cards, skipped files and duration.

8. Screen reference

Element	Meaning
RAM available	Free memory now; under 900 MB the router goes offline-only, under 1400 MB it drops to the smaller model
Bandwidth	Current link speed; under 800 kbps the cloud leg is not attempted
Cloud quota	Simulated calls left today (100 per day)
Ollama	'loaded' when the local model answers; 'model not pulled' when the server is up but the model is missing; 'unavailable' when the server cannot be reached. A line under the tiles names the command that fixes it
Requests by route	How questions were answered: cache, offline, local model, cloud
Latency p50 / p95	Answer time per route, in milliseconds
Cumulative cost	Simulated spend against the always-cloud baseline
Answer quality	Average confidence, groundedness and abstention over recent answers
Offline mode	The demo switch that forces the offline path, for showing the fallback

9. Troubleshooting

What you see	What it means	What to do
Ollama: model not pulled	The Ollama server the backend uses answered, but phi3:mini is not in its model store. A pull in the Windows/macOS Ollama app fills the host store and does not count	Pull it into the container: docker compose run --rm ollama-pull (or make models). The card recovers within 30 seconds; no restart needed
Ollama: unavailable	The backend cannot reach Ollama at the configured address	docker compose up -d ollama, or start ollama serve when the backend runs on the host
Degraded banner on an answer	The model was unreachable, so the extractive path answered	Check the Ollama card; the answer is still cited and correct, just quoted verbatim
503 Service unavailable	The backend is starting or a component is down	docker compose ps, then docker compose logs backend --tail 50
Not permitted (403)	Your role cannot use that route	Use the screen your role has; the navigation shows only those
Session expired	Idle timeout or a restarted server with a new key	Sign in again
Backend unreachable	The browser cannot reach the API	Check that port 8000 answers: curl http://localhost:8000/api/v1/health
Answer is slow (2-3 s)	The local model is answering rather than the cache or the extractive path	Expected; the route badge names the tier that answered

10. Privacy and limits

Every question is stored with its answer, route, cost and trace, so the evaluation and the audit trail have data to work with. The actor is the account, not a guess; staff access to a student record is written to the audit log, and a denied request is recorded with the route that denied it. There is no third-party call, no analytics, no telemetry - the only network traffic is the browser to the local API, and the API to MySQL and Ollama on loopback.

- It answers only from the corpus it was given; a question about next year's package or a private phone number is refused, not estimated.
- It cannot paraphrase well on the extractive path; expect quoted sentences.
- It reports conflicting documents rather than silently picking one.
- The demo accounts share a documented password. Change or remove them before any real deployment.

One-page rules of thumb: name the thing you are asking about; read the citations before quoting the answer; treat an abstention as information, not a failure; and never rely on the extractive answer for wording, only for the facts it cites.